

playing a video inside the bezel of a picture of a TV screen are impressive when you see it the first time, there's so much more that's doable.

We've partnered with Blippar for this issue to give you a taste and whet your appetite, and you will find a few more AR-able images as you go through the magazine, and also SKOAR!, so remember to keep an eye out for them.

THIRD EYE

A concept that all of us Indians are familiar with is the third eye. Usually symbolised by a tika or a bindi that we wear on our forehead, the idea is still basically a belief that humans can start sensing more than what's visible to all or easily sensed by the majority by meditating and attaining enlightenment. It's also a belief in the Chinese culture, and in many other Asian belief systems, which basically means that about half the world already accepts that augmentation of our experiences are very desirable, enough to spend years trying to get to that level.

So what's technology going to do here? Help you take a shortcut and not require years of dedicated meditation and learning of skills? Perhaps, yes. If the ability to "perceive the world better" is the art of learning how to use our third eye, then yes, technology is going to give us that shortcut.

How? Imagine that you can already use VR apps to look around you (mostly in the US for now), through products such as Google Glass, or your smartphone screen, and see information that you never ever could before.

For example, walking down a New York street with the right apps installed, you could look down a street and see what businesses/offices are inside which buildings; are they open right now?; how far to a hot dog?; which of the 16 pizza places nearby has the highest rating?; can you park a car here?; if so from what time to what time?; any cycle rental places around?; which street corner are you most likely to find a cab?; where's the closest subway station? Then, for those in a

tearing rush, as many of us are, when you do get to the subway, how do you know which subway car will drop you off closest to the exit at your destination stop? There truly is an app for everything.

Then there's guides for Central Park, information about ferries, all that touristy stuff, and even an app that augments your experience in the New York Public Library - not just the discovery of titles you haven't read, but creating lists, putting a title on hold for you to read, and doing a lot of what you would in person using your library account...

Remember, all of this is being done right now, just not in your city or country, but how long before it's common place globally? As we've suggested to you

before... globalisation was hot earlier, now it's all about localisation, because locally is where you live your life.

Although everyone attempts to build an app that no one with a smartphone in the world can live without, maybe the best way to start is to build an app that no one with a smartphone in Bengaluru can live without...

Google Glass and other AR wearables are attempting to give you the fabled "third eye", or basically any additional

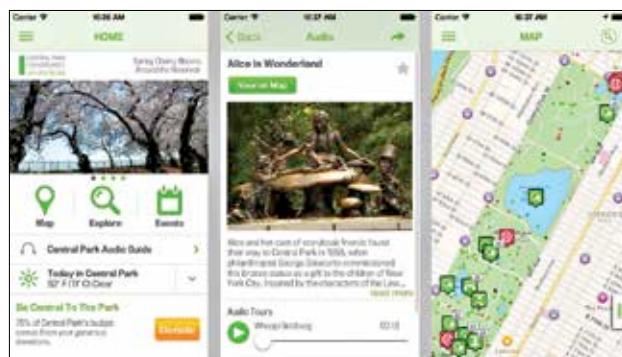
information that you deem to be important when outside in the "real world".

TYING IT ALL UP

The fact is technology is able to achieve AR today. Using your smartphone and a cellular data network, already you have access to all the information that's out there. You could be standing on a road in Bandra, Mumbai, not know where you are, and just tap on a map application to find out within a meter.

Hungry? You'd probably open up Zomato to see what's around you and choose a restaurant that has the kind of

cuisine you're hungering for, at the right budget, and also with recommendations from other foodies like you - perhaps even recommendations from some of your friends.



A must-have app if you're ever in New York and just want to take some time out to chill in the park

Just the way we use map data would be astonishing for someone who's lived under a rock for five or six years. It's also perfect for stereo-typical men who hate asking for directions... Think about it. Today, with Google Maps and a cellular data connection, you are able to travel almost fearlessly in most major cities around the globe. Although you may think of this as just reality, or the "way it is", it's actually augmented or enhanced reality. However, it's also augmented and enhanced you to the point where what once used to be a hard and scary task, now is commonplace. Technology has made us bolder travelers for sure, amongst many other things.

What we really need, however, is a way to tie it all up, and provide an almost seamless experience based on our individual needs.

For example, assume that you are a person who travels abroad a lot, and thus are always in new cities and need to find your way around the place. You also need a lot of help calculating currency



At close to a lakh (\$1,500) the cost for this is certainly not worth it right now. Maybe once there are a million apps for it...



An idol of Shiva from Cambodia depicting the third eye - the power of the gods?